

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 20)

Page 97 - The Restoration and French Influence

Q1. During the Restoration, what happened to poetry?

- A. It reached its most emotional and imaginative heights
- B. It became prosaic, was made to do the work of prose, and judged by the standards of prose
- C. It was outlawed completely
- D. It was only written in blank verse

Answer: B

Q2. Instead of exploring fairyland or mysteries like Spenser and Milton, what did poets of this era use their verse for?

- A. For writing purely religious hymns
- B. As the vehicle of argument, controversy, personal and political satire
- C. For writing long, romantic epics
- D. For writing scientific textbooks

Answer: B

Q3. The era of what began during this time, illustrating the changed mood?

- A. The era of the short story
- B. The era of the versified pamphlet
- C. The era of the gothic novel
- D. The era of free verse

Answer: B

Q4. Which country exerted a direct and powerful influence on English literature during the Restoration?

- A. Italy
- B. Spain
- C. France
- D. Germany

Answer: C

Q5. Contemporary French literature (the arbiter of taste) was characterized by what?

- A. Wild emotionalism and total lack of form

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 20)

- B. Lucidity, vivacity, correctness, elegance, and finish
- C. Dark, gothic horror and suspense
- D. Deeply mystical religious allegory

Answer: B

Q6. French literature was essentially the literature of what?

- A. The peasant class
- B. Polite society (where intellect was ascendant and the critical faculty in control)
- C. The priesthood
- D. The military

Answer: B

Q7. What was the inevitable result of cultivating the principles of regularity, order, and good sense at the expense of feeling and spontaneity?

- A. A new golden age of romanticism
- B. The growth of an artificial type of poetry
- C. The total death of the English language
- D. A return to the style of Chaucer

Answer: B

Q8. What significant fact is stated regarding the men of the Restoration and English prose?

- A. They abandoned prose entirely for poetry
- B. They were the real creators of our modern English prose
- C. They only wrote prose in Latin
- D. They refused to write prose that was clear or understandable

Answer: B

Q9. How is the literature of the Restoration period described compared to earlier eras?

- A. Intellectual rather than imaginative or emotional; a trifle hard and unsympathetic
- B. The most emotional period in English history
- C. Entirely focused on medieval legends
- D. Completely lacking in any intellectual thought

Answer: A

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 20)

Q10. Who has been called 'the greatest man of a little age' and was the one complete representative of this epoch?

- A. John Milton
- B. John Dryden
- C. Edmund Waller
- D. Sir John Denham

Answer: B

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 20)

Page 98 - Waller, Denham, and Dryden's Early Life

Q1. Which two writers are commonly considered the pioneers of the 'classic' school of poetry and the forerunners of Dryden?

- A. Shakespeare and Marlowe
- B. Edmund Waller and Sir John Denham
- C. Milton and Spenser
- D. Herrick and Lovelace

Answer: B

Q2. What were Waller and Denham leaders of?

- A. The rebellion against the King
- B. The reaction in taste against the excesses/obscurity of the metaphysical poets, in favor of good sense and neatness
- C. The movement to ban poetry
- D. The return to blank verse

Answer: B

Q3. On what side mainly do Waller and Denham possess historical importance?

- A. They were the greatest playwrights of the era
- B. They were the reformers of English versification at a time when it had become insufferably rugged and harsh
- C. They invented the English novel
- D. They translated the Bible

Answer: B

Q4. What did Dryden praise Edmund Waller for teaching?

- A. 'The excellence and dignity of rime'
- B. 'The beauty of blank verse'
- C. 'The power of the sonnet'
- D. 'The grace of the epic'

Answer: A

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 20)

Q5. What was Waller's principal claim to distinction?

- A. He wrote Paradise Lost
- B. His reshaping of the heroic couplet (bringing into use the 'classic' or 'closed' form)
- C. He invented the printing press
- D. He was the first Poet Laureate

Answer: B

Q6. What is the rule of the 'classic' or 'closed' heroic couplet?

- A. The sense flows on indefinitely for many lines
- B. The sense habitually closes with the end of the second line (metrical and rhetorical pause come together)
- C. It must not contain any rhymes
- D. It must be written in French

Answer: B

Q7. Did Waller actually invent the closed couplet?

- A. Yes, he was the first person ever to use it
- B. No, Dryden was wrong; it had been used by earlier writers, but Waller led the new movement towards it
- C. Yes, and he patented the form
- D. No, it was invented by Shakespeare

Answer: B

Q8. In whose hands did the classic couplet first assume perfection?

- A. Dryden
- B. Waller
- C. Pope
- D. Denham

Answer: C

Q9. What descriptive poem is Sir John Denham chiefly remembered for?

- A. Absalom and Achitophel
- B. Cooper's Hill
- C. Religio Laici

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 20)

D. Annus Mirabilis

Answer: B

Q10. In what year was John Dryden born?

A. 1564

B. 1608

C. 1631

D. 1660

Answer: C

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 20)

Page 99 - Dryden's Career

Q1. Dryden's early poems 'Heroic Stanzas on the Death of Oliver Cromwell' (1659) and 'Astraea Redux' indicate what?

- A. His unwavering loyalty to the Puritans
- B. A rapid change of front (as he celebrated the restoration of Charles II shortly after Cromwell's death)
- C. His refusal to write about politics
- D. His hatred of the monarchy

Answer: B

Q2. Why did Dryden begin working for the stage in 1663?

- A. He loved acting more than writing
- B. It was then the only profitable field for anyone who had to depend on his pen for his livelihood
- C. The King ordered him to write plays
- D. He wanted to rival Shakespeare

Answer: B

Q3. In what year was John Dryden made Poet Laureate?

- A. 1631
- B. 1660
- C. 1670
- D. 1688

Answer: C

Q4. What great verse satire did Dryden publish in 1681?

- A. Religio Laici
- B. The Hind and the Panther
- C. Absalom and Achitophel
- D. Annus Mirabilis

Answer: C

Q5. Which theological poem was an elaborate argument in favor of Roman Catholicism, to which he had converted?

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 20)

- A. Religio Laici
- B. The Hind and the Panther
- C. Absalom and Achitophel
- D. MacFlecknoe

Answer: B

Q6. Because of his change of religion, what happened to Dryden after the Revolution of 1688?

- A. He was made King
- B. He was executed
- C. He lost his position of poet laureate and all hopes of official recognition
- D. He was exiled to France

Answer: C

Q7. What volume of paraphrases from Homer, Ovid, Boccaccio, and Chaucer did Dryden publish in 1699, shortly before his death?

- A. The Canterbury Tales
- B. Fables
- C. Metamorphoses
- D. The Faerie Queene

Answer: B

Q8. How did Dryden develop as a poet?

- A. He was brilliant from his first poem
- B. He ripened very slowly (his first poem at eighteen was 'incredibly bad')
- C. He wrote all his best work before he was 20
- D. He only wrote one poem in his life

Answer: B

Q9. Who greatly influenced Dryden in his youth, causing his early works to abound in characteristic absurdities of the metaphysical school?

- A. Spenser
- B. Shakespeare
- C. Cowley

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 20)

D. Milton

Answer: C

Q10. What poem about the war with Holland and the Fire of London still indulges in fantastic conceits (like the Deity putting out the fire with a crystal pyramid)?

A. Annus Mirabilis

B. Absalom and Achitophel

C. The Medal

D. Fables

Answer: A

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 20)

Page 100 - Dryden's Masterpieces

Q1. Where do we turn to see the full exhibition of Dryden's powers and complete emancipation from false metaphysical taste?

- A. His early college poems
- B. The work of the last twenty years of his life
- C. His first play
- D. The poems he wrote at age 27

Answer: B

Q2. Dryden's mature work marks the definite establishment of what in England?

- A. The romantic school of poetry
- B. The classical school of poetry
- C. The metaphysical school of poetry
- D. The Gothic novel

Answer: B

Q3. Against whom was 'Absalom and Achitophel' written to defend the King's policy?

- A. Oliver Cromwell
- B. The Earl of Shaftesbury
- C. Thomas Shadwell
- D. The Duke of Buckingham

Answer: B

Q4. Under what name is the Earl of Shaftesbury satirized in 'Absalom and Achitophel'?

- A. Zimri
- B. Achitophel
- C. MacFlecknoe
- D. Absalom

Answer: B

Q5. Which poem is a scathing personal attack on his former friend Thomas Shadwell?

- A. Absalom and Achitophel

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 20)

- B. The Medal
- C. MacFlecknoe
- D. Religio Laici

Answer: C

Q6. How are the two great doctrinal poems ('Religio Laici' and 'The Hind and the Panther') described?

- A. Deeply devotional and spiritual
- B. Theological and controversial, not spiritual; exhibiting his mastery in the conduct of an argument in verse
- C. Written entirely in prose
- D. Short, comedic love poems

Answer: B

Q7. What did Dryden's mental flexibility and agility give him remarkable power as?

- A. A playwright
- B. A special pleader (able to argue whatever position he adopted)
- C. A scientific researcher
- D. A spiritual mystic

Answer: B

Q8. Written under the increasing burden of age and ill-health, what do Dryden's 'Fables' show?

- A. A massive decline in his abilities
- B. They show the poet almost at his best, ranking him among our best story-tellers in verse
- C. That he had forgotten how to write in English
- D. That he hated storytelling

Answer: B

Q9. Which of the 'Fables' provides an instructive comparison between the methods of the 14th and 17th centuries, based on Chaucer's Knight's Tale?

- A. Palamon and Arcite
- B. The Nun's Priest's Tale
- C. The Wife of Bath's Tale
- D. The Miller's Tale

Answer: A

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 20)

Q10. What is Dryden's poetry generally wanting (lacking) in?

- A. Intellectuality and manly vigor
- B. Essentially poetic qualities (imaginative power, depth of feeling, spiritual glow)
- C. Clear grammar
- D. Satirical power

Answer: B

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 20)

Page 101 - Dryden's Style and Samuel Butler

Q1. Though lacking spiritual glow, what is Dryden's poetry characterized by?

- A. Extreme emotionalism
- B. Splendid intellectuality and a manly vigour of style
- C. Complete obscurity
- D. A deep love of nature

Answer: B

Q2. In what two fields does Dryden still hold his own as our greatest master?

- A. As a lyric poet and romantic
- B. As a satirist and as a reasoner in verse
- C. As a writer of blank verse and sonnets
- D. As a writer of pastoral elegies

Answer: B

Q3. Whose influence and example lifted the classic couplet into the place it was to occupy for many years as the accepted measure of serious English poetry?

- A. Edmund Waller
- B. John Dryden
- C. Samuel Butler
- D. Sir John Denham

Answer: B

Q4. With which poem did Dryden make his final choice of the regular couplet, proving its capabilities and assuring its success?

- A. Annus Mirabilis
- B. Astraea Redux
- C. Absalom and Achitophel
- D. Heroic Stanzas

Answer: C

Q5. Who is the author of the famous satirical work 'Hudibras' (published 1663-1678)?

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 20)

- A. John Dryden
- B. Samuel Butler
- C. Thomas Shadwell
- D. Edmund Waller

Answer: B

Q6. What is 'Hudibras' a satire on?

- A. The Monarchy
- B. The Puritans
- C. The French
- D. The Catholic Church

Answer: B

Q7. How did 'Hudibras' affect the general reaction against the 'saints' (Puritans)?

- A. It stopped the reaction entirely
- B. It instantly hit the taste of the time and greatly stimulated the general reaction
- C. It caused people to sympathize with the Puritans
- D. It had no effect because no one read it

Answer: B

Q8. Upon what Spanish burlesque romance is the machinery of 'Hudibras' obviously fashioned?

- A. The Canterbury Tales
- B. Don Quixote
- C. The Decameron
- D. Arcadia

Answer: B

Q9. How is the central figure, the Presbyterian Sir Hudibras, described?

- A. As a perfect hero
- B. As a military enthusiast who, though unconsciously a bit of a hypocrite, is not consciously insincere
- C. As a vulgar, canting impostor
- D. As a brilliant scientist

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 20)

Answer: B

Q10. How is Hudibras's attendant, Ralpho, described?

- A. As a loyal, heroic knight
- B. As a vulgar, canting impostor who assumes the mask of virtue for his own profit
- C. As a wise philosopher
- D. As an innocent child

Answer: B